

SSA Application Assistance — Adult Complete Worksheet: SSI, SSDI & DAC

For adults applying for disability — including young adults turning 18. Use it together with the steps in this packet to do the application yourself. If you need help, book a Zoom with us and we will guide you.

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Your \$50 Complete Package — What You Get

- ☐ This complete worksheet, to fill in as you go
- ☐ Step-by-step ID.me setup — where to go, and the papers to have ready
- ☐ **Step-by-step help to do the application yourself.** Most of the questions on the application come from your intake answers — answer each question correctly. **Save the Reference # SSA gives you. That is how you get back in.** If you need help, book a Zoom appointment with us (30 minutes, \$26) and we will guide you. Email southernoakfw@gmail.com.

Part 1 — The Three Programs, In Plain Language

SSI (Supplemental Security Income) — for people with low income and few resources who are disabled (or blind, or 65+). You do not need a work history. The resource limit is \$2,000 for one person. Your home and usually one vehicle do not count.

SSDI (Social Security Disability Insurance) — for people who worked and paid into Social Security and earned enough credits. The amount you get depends on your past earnings.

DAC (Disabled Adult Child benefits) — for an adult whose disability began before age 22, paid on a parent's work record, when that parent has retired, become disabled, or passed away. Many young adults who age out of child SSI can get DAC later. It often pays more than SSI and can lead to Medicare. Ask Social Security about it. Many people miss it.

The disability test for adults: your condition must keep you from doing substantial work. It must have lasted — or be expected to last — at least 12 months. Social Security uses a 5-step review. They look hard at your past work, and at whether other work is realistic for you.

Part 2 — About You

Full name	
Date of birth	
Social Security number	
Phone and email	

Mailing address

Diagnoses / conditions

Date you stopped working
(or reduced hours)

Are you applying for: SSI /
SSDI / DAC (circle)

If DAC: parent's name and
status (retired, disabled,
deceased)

Part 3 — Documents Checklist

- ☐ Birth certificate and Social Security card; proof of citizenship or legal status
- ☐ Medical records — every doctor, hospital, clinic, and therapist, with visit dates
- ☐ Medication list — name, dose, who prescribed it, and side effects
- ☐ Work history — jobs from the last 5 years: employer, dates, duties, lifting, standing, skills
- ☐ For SSI: proof of income and resources — bank statements, pay stubs, benefits letters
- ☐ For SSDI: most recent tax return or W-2 (helps confirm your earnings record)
- ☐ For DAC: your parent's Social Security information and proof of their retirement, disability, or death
- ☐ School records (young adults): IEPs, 504 plans, transition assessments, final school records
- ☐ Names and contact information for people who know how your condition affects you daily

Part 4 — How to Apply, Step by Step

Step 1 — Protect your filing date. Start the application right away: online at ssa.gov, by phone at 1-800-772-1213 (TTY 1-800-325-0778), or in person at your local office. The date you start can affect how much back pay you receive.

Step 2 — Check which programs to file for. Ask Social Security to check you for SSI, SSDI, AND DAC if a parent is retired, disabled, or deceased and your disability began before 22. Filing for one does not always file for the others — ask and write down the answer.

Step 3 — Complete the Adult Disability Report. List every condition together, every provider, and every medicine. Social Security must consider all of your conditions combined.

Step 4 — Complete the Work History Report. Describe each job from the last 5 years honestly: what you lifted, how long you stood or sat, the skills it took. Past work is a big part of the adult decision.

Step 5 — Complete the Function Report. This is your daily-life story: what a typical day looks like, what you can no longer do, and what help you need. Use Part 5 of this worksheet to prepare.

Step 6 — Keep treatment going and answer everything. Go to appointments, attend any consultative exam Social Security schedules, and open every letter the day it arrives.

Step 7 — The decision and appeals. A first decision commonly takes 3 to 6 months. If denied, you generally have 60 days to appeal: reconsideration, then a hearing in front of a judge, then the Appeals Council, then federal court. Many strong cases are approved at the hearing step. If you are denied, email us right away — see “If You Are Denied” below.

The Remarks Box — What to Write

Near the end of the online application, Social Security gives you a box called **Remarks**. There is no question in it. It is an open box for **extra information — anything you want to add, or anything that did not fit in the other parts**. If it does not all fit, SSA says to write it on a separate sheet of paper. Mail it to the address they give you at the end of the application.

Use the Remarks box for:

- ☐ Extra doctors, hospitals, clinics, or therapists that did not fit in the medical sections
- ☐ Extra conditions, or more detail about a condition
- ☐ How your condition limits your daily life and your ability to work, in real examples
- ☐ Hospital or ER visits, and medication side effects
- ☐ When things started or changed — including when you stopped working or cut your hours
- ☐ A note if you are mailing records or forms separately, so SSA knows they are coming

Draft your remarks here first — plain words and real examples help the most:

Do not leave the Remarks box blank if there is anything extra Social Security should know. It is the one place in the application where you can explain things in your own words.

Part 5 — Your Function Report Worksheet

Prepare your honest answers here before you fill in Social Security's form. Describe a hard day, not your best day — and explain what has changed since your condition began.

A typical day, from waking to bedtime — what you do, and what you can no longer do

Personal care — dressing, bathing, grooming, eating — what help do you need?

Meals, housework, and yard work — what you can do, what you had to stop, how long things take

Getting around — driving, riding, walking — limits on distance, standing, sitting, lifting

Shopping and money — can you shop alone, pay bills, count change, follow a budget?

Social life and hobbies — what you used to enjoy and what has changed

Concentration and memory — finishing tasks, following instructions, handling stress and changes

Pain and other symptoms — where, how often, what makes it better or worse, medication side effects

If You Are Denied — Get Connected

If you are denied — do not let the deadline pass. Email us the same week at southernoakfw@gmail.com. You generally have only 60 days to appeal, so do not let that deadline go by. We will connect you with special needs attorneys who can further help you more with your case. The attorney does not charge an upfront fee — they are paid only if you win.

Part 6 — After an Approval

- ☐ SSDI: there is a 5-month wait from when your disability began before payments start. Medicare begins 24 months after SSDI payments start, most of the time
- ☐ SSI: payments generally start from the month after you applied or became eligible; Medicaid in Texas usually follows SSI
- ☐ DAC: ask about Medicare after 24 months on DAC, and tell Social Security about marriage or work — both can affect DAC
- ☐ Report changes: returning to work, moving, or changes in income or living arrangements
- ☐ Keep your records: approval letters, payment information, and review notices. Reviews happen from time to time — keep your medical care going

Please read: This worksheet is an educational tool only. It is not legal, tax, medical, or financial advice, and Southern Oak Financial & Wellness is not a law firm and does not provide legal representation. Social Security rules change — confirm current details at ssa.gov or with Social Security before you act. There is no guarantee of approval for any benefit: only the Social Security Administration decides claims. Timelines are common ranges, not promises. This worksheet is for your family's personal use only — no refunds.